

Ready to roll: Manika Batra (**right**) was signed by Ahmedabad SG Pipers, while Bernadette Szocs (**below**) will play for U Mumba TT. R. RAGU & M. VEDHAN



SQUADS

Dempo Goa Challengers

Zeng Jian, Harmeet Desai, Tiago Apolonia, Ronit Bhanja, Krittwika Sinha Roy, Sayali Wani

Chennai Lions

Kiril Gerassimenko, Payas Jain, Sudhanshu Grover, Fan Siqi, Nikhat Banu, Jennifer Varghese

Dabang Delhi TTC

Diya Chitale, Maria Xiao, G. Sathiyar, Quek Izaac, Suhana Saini, Sourav Saha

PBG Pune Jaguars

Alvaro Robles, Anirban Ghosh, Mudit Dani, Dina Meshref, Reeth Rishya, Taneesha Kotecha

U Mumba TT

Lilian Bardet, Akash Pal, P.B. Abhinandh, Bernadette Szocs, Yashaswini Ghorpade, Swastika Ghosh

Kolkata Thunder Blades

Quadri Aruna, Ankur Bhattacharjee, Deepit Patil, Adriana Diaz, Selena Selvakumar, Ananya Chande

Jaipur Patriots

Britt Eerland, Kanak Jha, Sreeja Akula, Jeet Chandra, Pritha Vartikar, Yashansh Malik

Ahmedabad SG Pipers

Manika Batra, Ricardo Walther, SFR Snehit, Giorgia Piccolin, Divyansh Srivastava, Yashini Sivashankar



of Gujarat's finest players, Manav and Manush, will miss this season due to commitments in other foreign leagues.

"There are many rules across multiple leagues around the world that state that if someone is playing in one league, they cannot play in another. There will inevitably be some clash somewhere. Sometimes, we don't have a choice and will miss out on some good talent. But this also creates opportunities for younger and promising players. Our junior players will also be introduced to and gain exposure through the league," said Dani. While the single-city editions of 2019 (Delhi) and 2023 (Pune) had better turnout, the previous season in Chennai recorded an average footfall of just 600 per match, despite home favourites Sharath and Sathiyar in action.

Dani emphasised that the focus is on organic audience growth: "We want people to come for the sport itself. For that, we need to take the game to the people. That's why we have been to different venues. In some places, you feel only 700 people have come because the venues are larger-than-life. We want the right audience — those who attend because they genuinely want to."

